

033. Chapter 3 Verses 22-26

Lectures by Swami Sarvapriyananda

VERSE 3.22

न मे पार्थास्ति कर्तव्यं त्रिषु लोकेषु किञ्चन ।
नानवाप्तमवाप्तव्यं वर्त एव च कर्मणि ॥ 22 ॥

*na me pārthāsti kartavyam triṣhu lokeṣhu kiñchana
nānavāptam avāptavyam varta eva cha karmaṇi*

na—not; me—mine; pārtha—Arjun; asti—is; kartavyam—duty; triṣhu—in the three; lokeṣhu—worlds; kiñchana—any; na—not; anavāptam—to be attained; avāptavyam—to be gained; varte—I am engaged; eva—yet; cha—also; karmaṇi—in prescribed duties

There is no duty for me to do in the three worlds. There is nothing unattained or to be attained for me. And yet I am also engaged in work.

VERSE 3.23

यदि ह्यहं न वर्तेयं जातु कर्मण्यतन्द्रितः ।
मम वर्त्मानुवर्तन्ते मनुष्याः पार्थ सर्वशः ॥ 23 ॥

*yadi hyaham na varteyam jātu karmaṇyatandritaḥ
mama vartmānuvartante manuṣhyāḥ pārtha sarvaśhaḥ*

yadi—if; hi—certainly; aham—I; na—not; varteyam—thus engage; jātu—ever; karmaṇi—in the performance of prescribed duties; atandritaḥ—carefully; mama—my; vartma—path; anuvartante—follow; manuṣhyāḥ—all men; pārtha—Arjun, the son of Pritha; sarvaśhaḥ—in all respects

If I am not engaged in action always, without relaxation, men follow my path in every way, O Arjuna!

उत्सीदेयुरिमे लोका न कुर्यां कर्म चेदहम् ।
सङ्करस्य च कर्ता स्यामुपहन्यामिमाः प्रजाः ॥ 24 ॥

*utsīdeyur ime lokā na kuryām karma ched aham
sankarasya cha kartā syām upahanyām imāḥ prajāḥ*

utsīdeyuh—would perish; **ime**—all these; **lokāḥ**—worlds; **na**—not; **kuryām**—I perform; **karma**—prescribed duties; **chet**—if; **aham**—I; **sankarasya**—of uncultured population; **cha**—and; **kartā**—responsible; **syām**—would be; **upahanyām**—would destroy; **imāḥ**—all these; **prajāḥ**—living entities

These worlds would perish if I do not perform work; I would be the cause of the confusion of species and the destruction of these beings.

सक्ताः कर्मण्यविद्वांसो यथा कुर्वन्ति भारत ।
कुर्याद्विद्वांस्तथासक्तश्चिकीर्षुर्लोकसंग्रहम् ॥ 25 ॥

*saktāḥ karmanya vidvāṁso yathā kurvanti bhārata
kuryād vidvāns tathāsaktaśchikīrṣhur loka-saṅgraham*

saktāḥ—attached; **karmaṇi**—duties; **avidvāṁsaḥ**—the ignorant; **yathā**—as much as; **kurvanti**—act; **bhārata**—scion of Bharat (Arjun); **kuryāt**—should do; **vidvān**—the wise; **tathā**—thus; **asaktaḥ**—unattached; **chikīrṣhuḥ**—wishing; **loka-saṅgraham**—welfare of the world

O Arjuna! As the ignorant men work with attachment to action, so should the wise act without attachment, for the welfare of the world.

न बुद्धिभेदं जनयेदज्ञानां कर्मसङ्गिनाम् ।
जोषयेत्सर्वकर्माणि विद्वान्युक्तः समाचरन् ॥ 26 ॥

*na buddhi-bhedaṁ janayed ajñānāṁ karma-saṅginām
joṣhayet sarva-karmāṇi vidvān yuktaḥ samācharan*

na—not; **buddhi-bhedam**—discord in the intellects; **janayet**—should create; **ajñānām**—of the ignorant; **karma-saṅginām**—who are attached to fruitive actions; **joṣhayet**—should inspire (them) to perform; **sarva**—all; **karmāṇi**—prescribed; **vidvān**—the wise; **yuktaḥ**—enlightened; **samācharan**—performing properly

The wise man should not disturb and confuse the minds of the ignorant attached to action. By performing all actions with yogic equanimity, they should make the ignorant do accordingly.